SPX Options Flow — Weekly Macro Briefing

Weekly Options Flow & Dealer Positioning Analysis

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▼ SHORT GAMMA

RISK: EXTREME

Composite Score: **-0.50**

SPX SPOT	NET GEX	GAMMA FLIP	DIST. TO FLIP	CALL WALL #1	PUT WALL #1
6,625	-3940.16B	7,155	-8.0%	6,625	6,625

MAX PAIN	VIX
6,690	26.81

Dealers are in SHORT GAMMA with net GEX of $-3940.16B. Spot (6,625) sits 8.0% below the gamma flip level (7,155). Composite macro score: -0.50 → Risk Level: EXTREME. Key risks: BEARISH_VOL_BUY, BELOW FLIP: BEARISH, OPEX 1DTE, DAILY_DELTA_OUTFLOW, BEARISH_SKEW_HEAVY.

REGIME PLAYBOOK

▲ EQUITIES
Reduce net delta, buy downside puts for protection

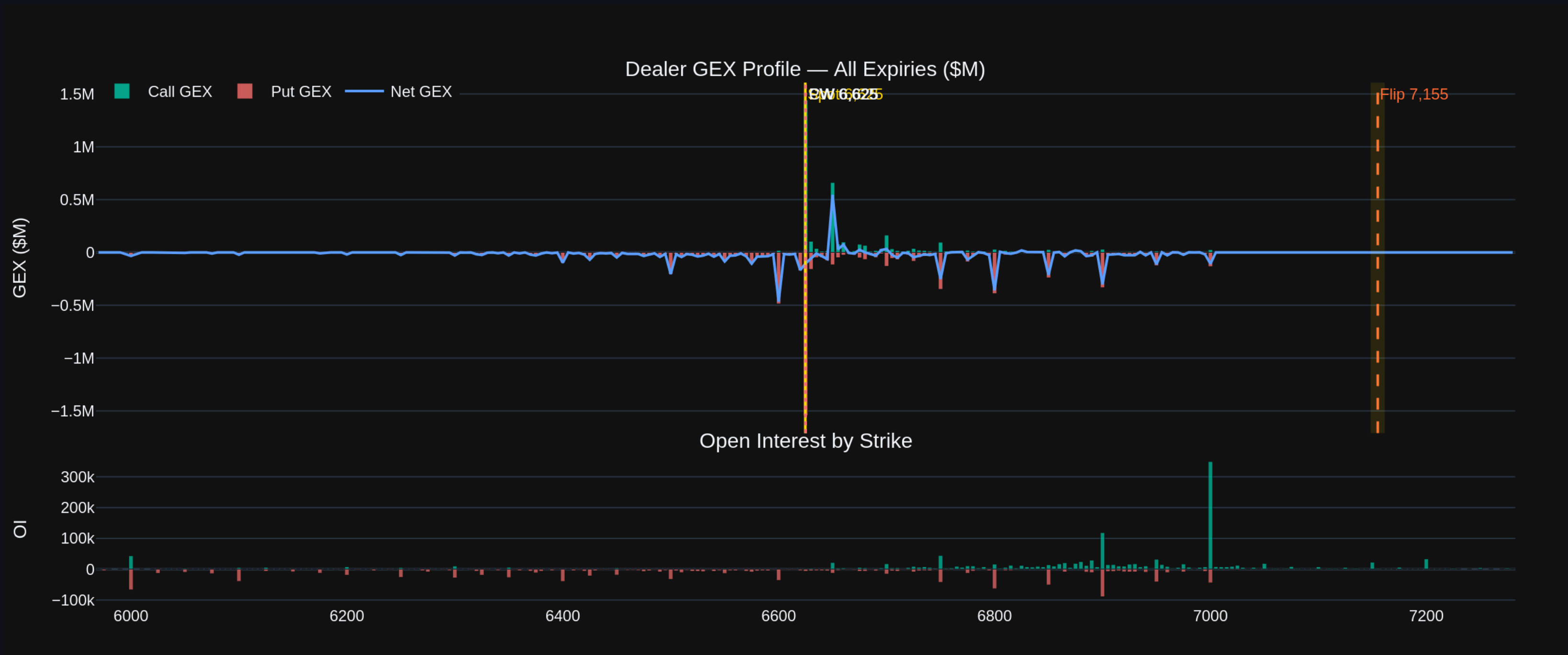
◆ VOLATILITY
Long VIX, buy volatility — trend moves may persist

◆ OPTIONS STRATEGY
Long straddles, buy gamma for directional exposure

◆ POSITION SIZING
Reduce 30–50% — elevated tail risk in short-gamma regime

GEX Profile — Dealer Gamma Exposure

March 19, 2026



KEY LEVELS

STRIKE	TYPE	GEX ($M)	DIST. FROM SPOT	INTERPRETATION
6,625	Call Wall	**+1441834M**	+0.0%	Strong resistance / dealer selling
6,650	Call Wall	**+662379M**	+0.4%	Strong resistance / dealer selling
6,700	Call Wall	**+163923M**	+1.1%	Strong resistance / dealer selling
6,625	Put Wall	**-1545026M**	+0.0%	Support / dealer delta hedge floor
6,600	Put Wall	**-486338M**	-0.4%	Support / dealer delta hedge floor
6,800	Put Wall	**-390235M**	+2.6%	Support / dealer delta hedge floor

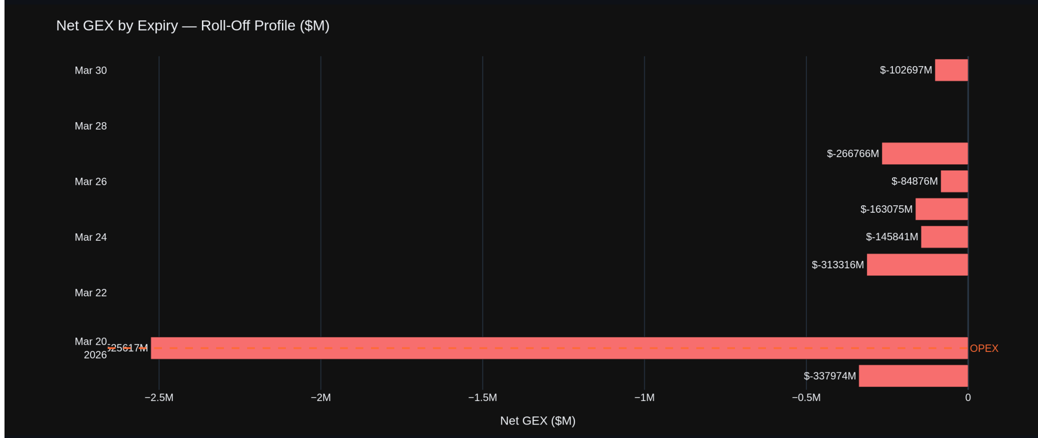
OPEX: 2026-03-20 (1 DTE)

Net GEX Expiring	% of Total Book
$-2525617M	64.1%

Expiry Roll-Off & Delta Exposure

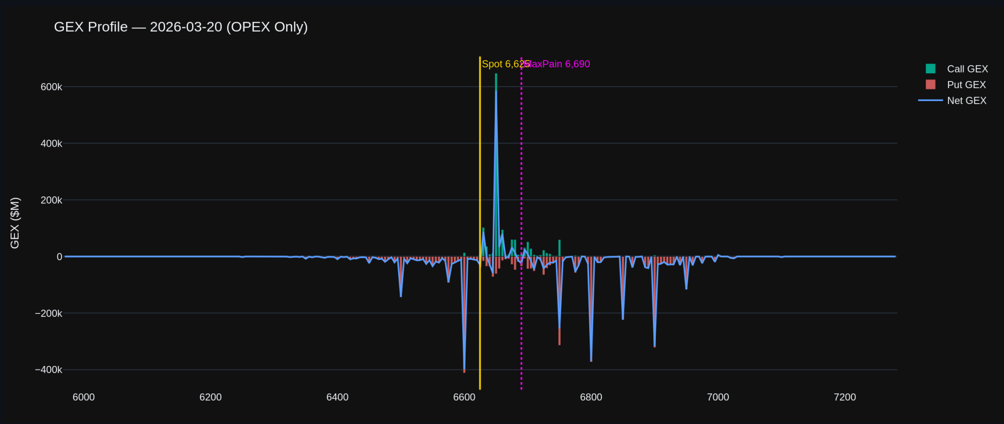
March 19, 2026

GEX BY EXPIRY



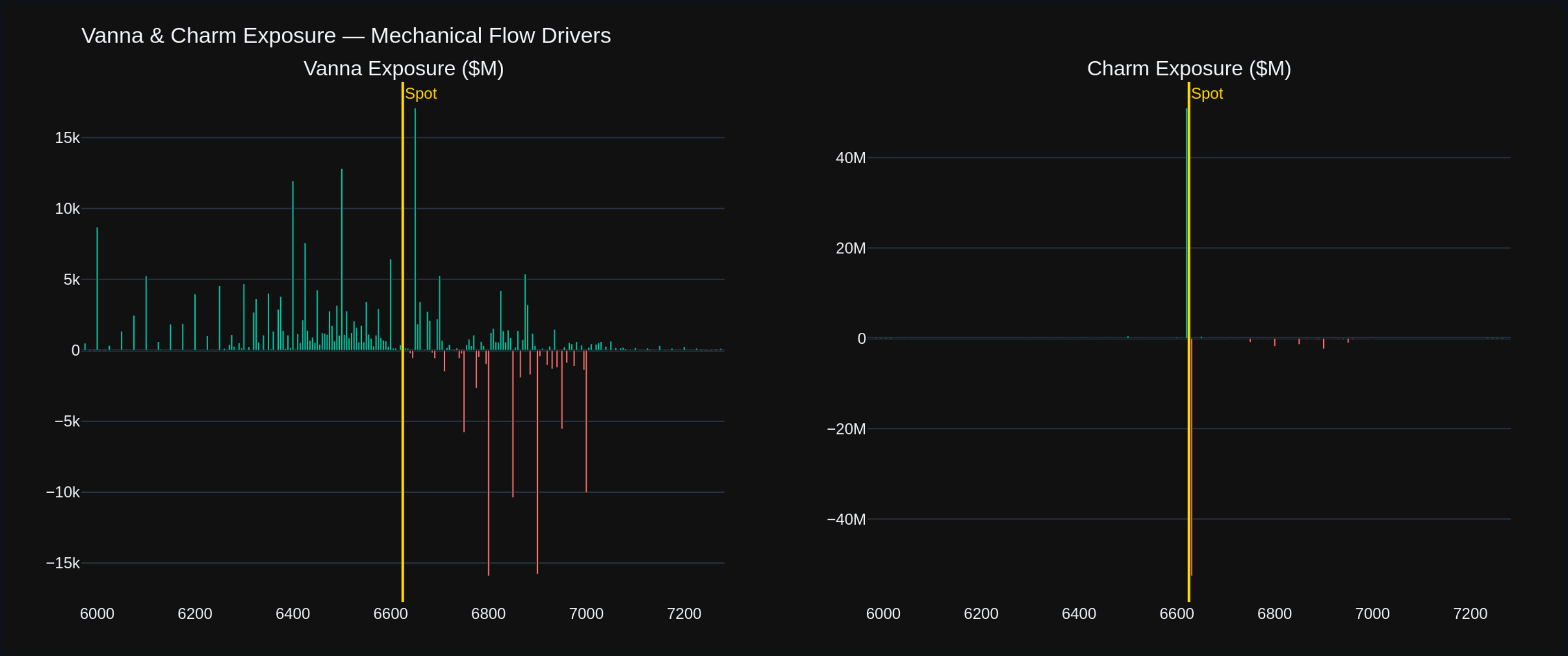
DEX PROFILE

OPEX-SPECIFIC GEX (2026-03-20)



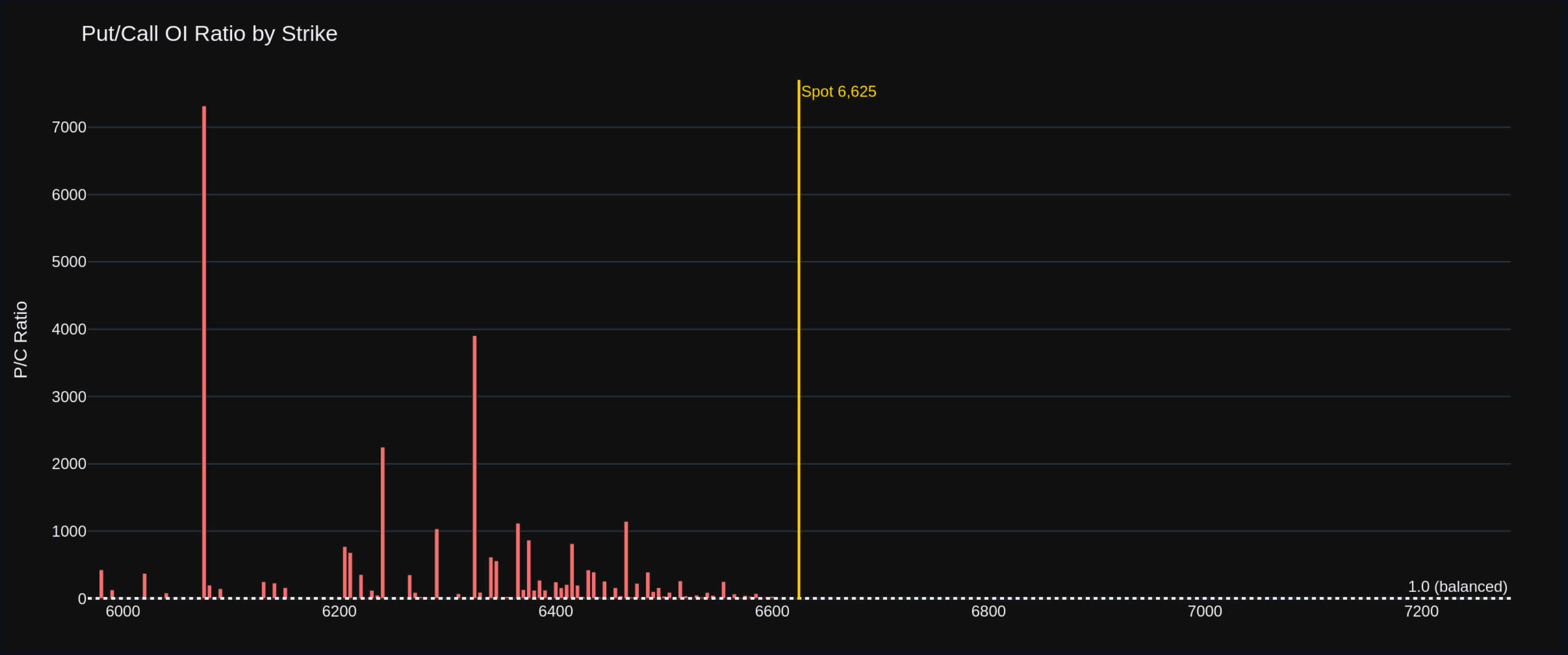
Max Pain: 6,690 — Market tends to gravitate toward max-pain strike in the final trading sessions before OPEX as dealers neutralise hedges.

VANNA & CHARM EXPOSURE



Vanna: dDelta/dSigma — when vol changes, dealers re-hedge delta mechanically. Positive vanna = vol compression drives equity buying. **Charm:** dDelta/dT — daily delta decay creates intraday mechanical flows even without price movement. Strongest near OPEX.

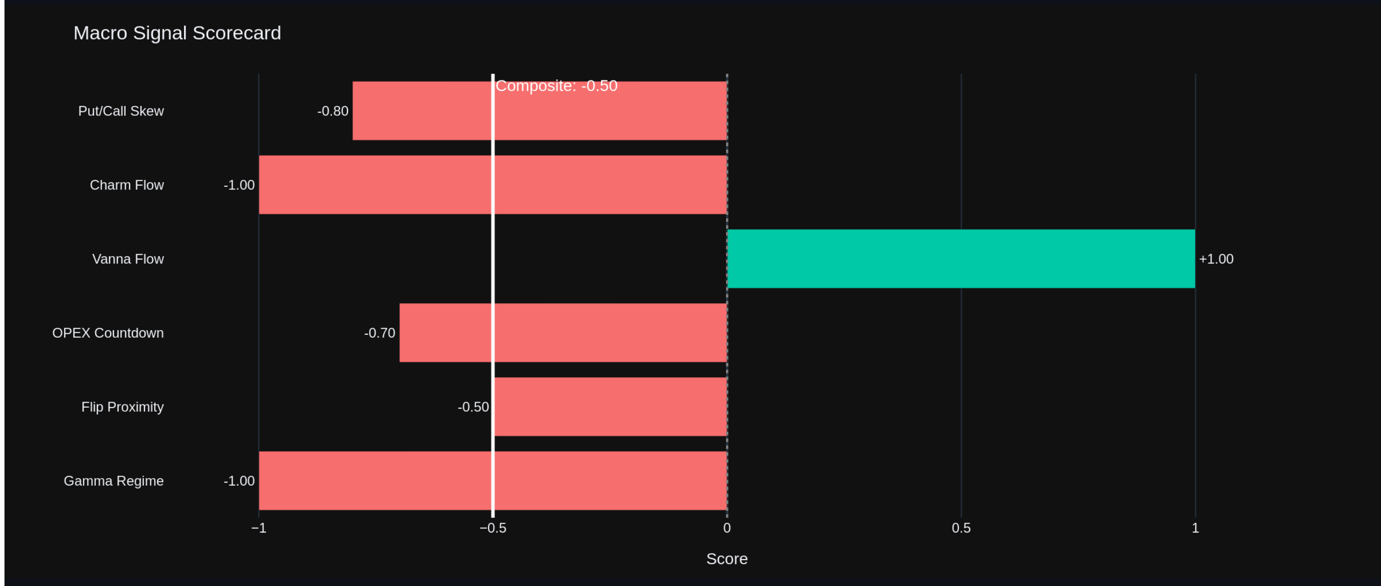
PUT/CALL OI RATIO

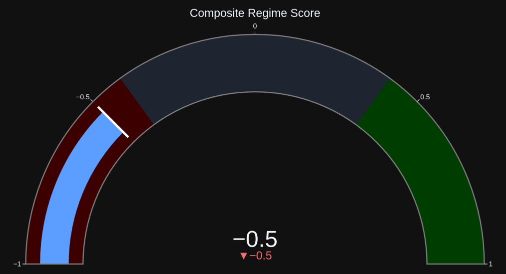


Put/Call Ratio: Values above 1.5 signal heavy defensive hedging by institutions. Put walls represent strikes where dealer short put hedging provides natural support on selloffs.

Macro Signal Dashboard

March 19, 2026





SIGNAL DETAIL

Gamma Regime

BEARISH_VOL_BUY

-1.00

STRONG

Net GEX = $-3940.16B → dealers are SHORT GAMMA. Spot is 8.0% below gamma flip at 7,155.

- Equities: trending moves more likely, reduce net delta exposure
- Vol: VIX spikes may persist — avoid short vol
- Options: long gamma / straddles for directional flexibility

Flip Proximity

BELOW FLIP: BEARISH

-0.50

MODERATE

Spot (6,625) is 8.0% below gamma flip (7,155). Dealers in short-gamma — trend-following mode, no natural support.

- Watch 7,155 as key inflection — sustained close above = regime shift
- Volatility clustering risk increases near flip

OPEX Countdown

OPEX 1DTE

-0.70

STRONG

OPEX in 1 DTE (CRITICAL urgency). $-2525617M net GEX expiring = 64.1% of total book. Pin behaviour likely near OPEX strikes.

- Pin risk: market may gravitate to max-pain strike ±0.5% as OPEX approaches
- Post-OPEX: expect vol reset once large GEX concentration expires
- Book impact: 64.1% of dealer delta hedging unwind at OPEX

Vanna Flow

VOL_FALL_BID

+1.00

STRONG

Vanna exposure = $+146716M. Vol compression → mechanical equity bid via delta re-hedging. VIX 1d change: +1.72 (rising) — diverging with vanna signal.

- Vol decline → dealer delta re-hedging creates systematic equity buying
- Watch VIX 1d direction as leading indicator of vanna flow direction
- Strong positive vanna + falling VIX = powerful mechanical tailwind

Charm Flow

DAILY_DELTA_OUTFLOW

-1.00

STRONG

Charm exposure = $-11203059M/day. DTE=0: charm acceleration is sharp near expiry. Negative charm = net delta drain as time passes.

- Charm creates mechanical daily delta flows even with no price movement
- Near OPEX, charm accelerates and can distort intraday price action

Put/Call Skew

BEARISH_SKEW_HEAVY

-0.80

STRONG

Put/Call GEX ratio = 2.07. Heavy put protection in dealer books — bearish defensive positioning. Put wall at 6,625 (+0.0% from spot).

- High put skew: dealers long delta hedge → can provide natural support near put walls
- Hedging demand exceeds upside speculation — institutional risk-off signal

Multi-Instrument Positioning

March 19, 2026

CROSS-ASSET GEX SUMMARY

INSTRUMENT	SPOT	NET GEX ($B)	REGIME	FLIP LEVEL	DIST. TO FLIP	CALL WALL	PUT WALL
SPX — S&P 500 Index	6,624.70	-3940.16B	SHORT GAMMA	7,155	-8.0%	6,625	6,625
SPY — SPDR S&P 500 ETF	661.43	+213.91B	LONG GAMMA	661	+0.1%	662	661
QQQ — Invesco QQQ ETF	594.90	+4601.48B	LONG GAMMA	594	+0.1%	595	594
IWM — iShares Russell 2000 ETF	246.02	+0.60B	LONG GAMMA	246	-0.1%	247	245

⚠ REGIME DIVERGENCE DETECTED — Cross-instrument positioning is mixed. Review individual instrument signals. Example: SPX long-gamma while IWM short-gamma = potential small-cap risk-off signal diverging from large-cap stability.

Cross-instrument divergences often precede sector rotations. When SPX is long-gamma but IWM is short-gamma, institutional flow is concentrated in mega-cap names with less protection in small caps. When QQQ gamma diverges from SPX, watch for tech-driven directional moves.